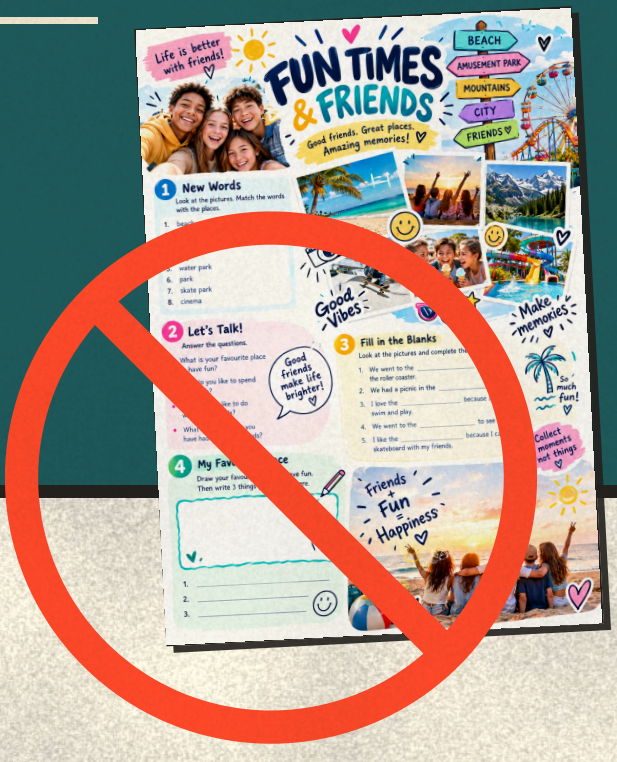
A PRACTICAL GUIDE TO BETTER AI TEACHING RESOURCES.

STOP THE SLOP

You're the boss.
AI is the team.



HOW TO USE AI WITHOUT HANDING OVER YOUR JUDGEMENT

PLAN · DRAFT · CHECK · DIAGNOSE · REPAIR · RE-CHECK · DECIDE

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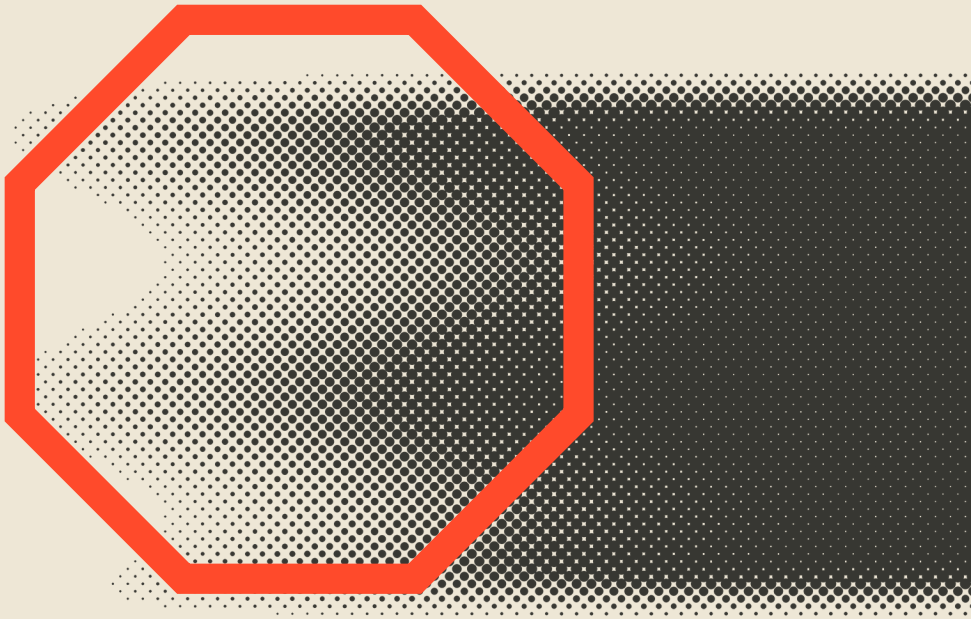
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START HERE

This guide is about making and checking teaching resources when AI has had a hand in them. It isn't trying to persuade you to use AI. If you do, it aims to keep you in charge of the result.

By **slop** it means output that hasn't been adequately examined, tested and improved for its intended use. Being made by AI doesn't define it: you can produce it yourself, and AI-assisted material can be carefully checked.

The method is: start from the objective, choose a format, plan, draft in parts, check, diagnose, repair, re-check, decide, then learn from use.

It grew out of making and checking about eighty classroom resources with AI tools, mostly ESL/EFL partner speaking activities, and out of the mistakes found along the way. Chapter 10 follows one of them. The checks work for any subject; the language-design advice is written for English learners.

It doesn't promise perfect resources, saved time, classroom success or an AI that can check itself. None of its prompts or checks has been tested in classrooms, and the example resources have been inspected as files, not taught. Treat every prompt as a suggestion; AI responses vary.

How to read the examples. Chapters 10 and 11 use information-gap activities (two sheets, each holding half the information) as worked examples because these are the resources documented in this project. The format is specific to those examples; the design and checking methods can be adapted to other kinds of teaching resources, such as a reading text, a vocabulary set, an explanation, a discussion task or a test. The table in Chapter 6 shows how the checks change.

AI tools did much of the drafting and building of this guide (Appendix B says how). Spelling is British; the examples use US formats because that is how they were made.

WHERE TO START

- **Unsure what to leave to AI, and what not to?** Chapter 1.
- **Want to spot weak material?** Chapter 2.
- **Not sure what kind of resource you need?** Chapter 3.
- **Starting a new resource, or adapting your own?** Chapters 3 to 5.

- **Need to check a resource, or found a problem?** Chapters 6 and 7. For a reading text, explanation, quiz or other non-pair resource, start with the table in Chapter 6.
- **PDF looks fine on screen, or about to share or sell it?** Chapter 8.
- **Used it in class, or making the same mistakes again?** Chapter 9.
- **Want to see it all on one example?** Chapter 10 (made with the method) and Chapter 11 (a one-shot).
- **About to paste something into an AI service?** Chapter 12.
- **Want a checklist, or the evidence limits?** Appendices A and B.



KEEP YOUR JUDGEMENT

There are two quite different ways to use AI.

AI REPLACING YOUR THINKING	AI HELPING WITH THE WORK AROUND YOUR THINKING
"Make me a worksheet on fractions."	"Here are my 20 fraction questions. Put them into a consistent format."
AI decides what students should do	You decide what students should do
You accept what comes back	You check what comes back against what you intended

This guide is about the right-hand column.

WHAT STAYS WITH YOU

Five decisions are yours, however much AI is involved:

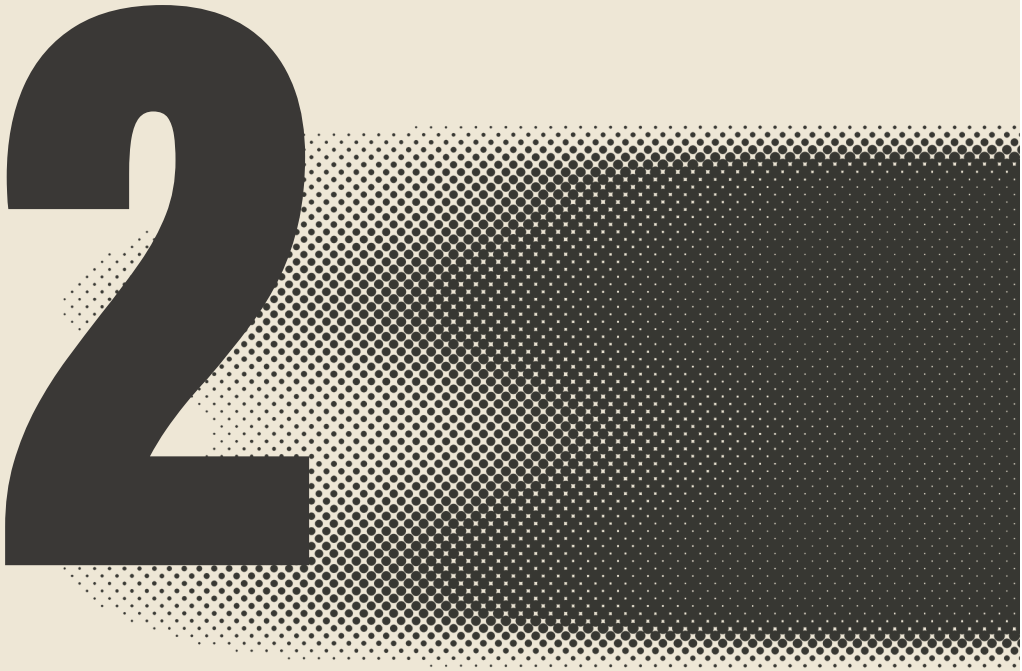
- **Purpose:** what your students need and what the resource is for.
- **The task:** what students actually do, and whether it takes thought.
- **Level:** whether it suits your students, not an AI's idea of them.
- **Accuracy:** whether the facts and answers are right.
- **The final decision:** whether the finished resource is good enough to use.

WHERE AI CAN HELP

Around those decisions, AI can take on repetitive work: drafting one part of a resource from your plan, formatting and numbering your questions, producing variations of something you've made, tidying and proofreading, drafting an answer key from your answers, simplifying instructions, or pointing out where pages disagree. You choose what to hand over. Some teachers use it for brainstorming. Some never let it write a word of student material and use it only to format and proofread. Both are reasonable, and you don't have to use it for everything.

Whatever it does, you examine the result before you use it. Chapters 3 to 11 show how.

Before you paste anything into an AI service, read Chapter 12 on privacy, copyright and your school's rules.



RECOGNISE THE SLOP

Slop is output that hasn't been adequately examined, tested and improved for its intended use. It isn't defined by who or what made it. The signs below are reasons to look closer, not proof of a problem, and a resource you made yourself can show every one of them.

SIGNS IN THE TASK

- **Nothing to decide.** Students could finish by copying, filling blanks or guessing, without making a choice.
- **No way in.** A student with only this page can't tell what to do, or the instructions refer to something that isn't on it. A worked example may even be one of the questions.
- **Level that drifts.** The vocabulary or thinking is well above or below your students, or changes partway through.

SIGNS BETWEEN THE PAGES

- **Pages that disagree.** Sheets give different names, numbers or situations. Matching versions (A and B, easier and harder) don't match.
- **Notes that don't fit the resource.** For example, the notes allow ten minutes for a "Task 3" on a two-task sheet, or timings that add up to more than the lesson.
- **An answer key that doesn't fit the task.** For example, "Answer: D" for a question with only three options, or a question with a second defensible answer.

SIGNS IN THE CONTENT

- **Suspicious facts.** Confident dates, figures, quotations or "did you know" facts with no source. A fluent sentence isn't evidence.
- **Filler.** Sections nobody would use in a lesson, or a vague setting that could be anywhere.
- **Leftovers.** Internal wording on a student or teacher page: placeholders, version labels, codes, or part of the request that produced it.

- **The same oddity everywhere.** If one resource has a strange feature, check whether your earlier ones copied it from the same template (Chapter 9 has a real case).

SIGNS ON THE PAGE

- **Layout problems.** A heading stranded at the foot of a page, a nearly empty page, text cut off, or a page count that doesn't match your notes.
- **Answers where students can see them.** An answer on a student page, or in a preview or thumbnail.

A PAGE TO PRACTISE ON

The worksheet on the cover is a made-up example, built for this guide to look finished and be badly designed. Try the quick check from Chapter 6 on it before you read on. A student holding only this page would run into these within a minute.



Figure 1. "Fun Times & Friends", a made-up worksheet used as the cover example.

- **Task 1 has nothing to match.** It says “Match the words with the places”, but the photos carry no numbers or letters to match against. Four of the eight words are already printed on the decorative signpost, and there is no picture of a cinema or an ordinary park.
- **Task 3 has no word bank, and some blanks fit two answers.** “I love the ___ because I can swim and play” could be the beach or the water park. Two sentences (the picnic and the movie) have no picture to look at.
- **Task 2 needs no thinking.** Four personal questions, no partner roles, no reason to listen, and no language to help a learner answer.
- **Task 4 is separate from the rest.** Draw a place and write three things; nothing links it to Tasks 1 to 3.
- **Decoration takes a large share of the page.** Photos, stickers and slogans compete with the tasks for room.
- **The page carries no level, time, teacher notes or answer key.**

Nothing on the page shows who made it. A person in a hurry could produce the same sheet. That is the point: slop is about whether anyone examined it.

Chapter 6 shows how to check, and Chapter 7 how to sort and repair what you find.



PLAN BEFORE YOU GENERATE

Planning first gives you a standard to check against (Chapters 6 to 8).

START FROM THE OBJECTIVE

"Make a worksheet" and "make an information-gap activity" are formats, not objectives. Let the objective decide the format. In order:

1. **Objective.** What should students be able to do afterwards that they can't do now? Use a verb you could watch or mark.
2. **Evidence.** What would a student say or produce to show it?
3. **Need.** What is in their way: missing knowledge, too little practice, a wrong idea, no chance to use it with others, or no way yet to tell whether it has stuck?
4. **Format.** Which resource gets them from the need to the evidence?

IF THE NEED IS…	A RESOURCE THAT MAY SUIT IT
Missing knowledge	An explanation, reading text or worked example
Too little practice	A practice set or vocabulary activity with answers
A wrong idea	A task whose answers expose it, then discussion
Using ideas with others	A discussion task, role play or pair task
Knowing whether it has stuck	A short assessment

Information gap, where each partner holds different information, suits an objective about asking and answering to get information. For most other objectives a simpler format will do.

If you'd like options, you could try:

> I teach [subject, age, level]. Objective: students will be able to [verb and content]. What is in their way: [the need]. Don't write any material. Suggest three different kinds of resource that could get them there. For each, say what students would produce as evidence, roughly how long it would take, and one way it could go wrong. Say which you are least sure suits this objective.

The choice is yours. If none fits, tell the AI what's missing and ask again.

THE PLAN

Once you have a format, jot down a line for each. Not every line applies to every format; the first two always do.

- **Students finish by…** What do they decide, produce, solve or say at the end? This is the evidence from the step above.
- **They can't do it without…** What information or thinking does the task need?
- **Who holds what (information-gap tasks only).** If students work in pairs with different information: which facts are on which sheet? Neither sheet should work alone.
- **The tricky part is…** What makes it worth doing?
- **Who it's for:** age, level, subject, language needs.
- **How long:** a realistic time, with steps that add up.
- **Layout and file:** how many pages or slides, which are for students and which for you, print or screen, paper size.
- **The answers:** if the task has right answers, decide them now, before any material is written, so the key can't drift to fit the text.

You can do this alone. An AI can turn rough notes into these headings or suggest options, but whether it's a good activity for your students is your call.

WHAT A GOOD RESOURCE HAS

These are the qualities to plan for and later check against; Chapter 2 lists their opposites.

- **A clear job.** Every page or section has a use in the lesson. If you'd skip it in a real lesson, cut it.
- **Instructions a student can start from.** A short box at the top of each student page says what to do and what the goal is.
- **Thinking where it counts.** In practice tasks, students decide, solve, explain or produce, not only copy, unless drill is the aim.

- **A level that fits your students,** judged against them, not an AI's idea of a grade.
- **Student and teacher material kept apart,** with one name for each thing on every page.
- **A structure you can see.** Titles, instructions and answer spaces are easy to tell apart, and each step builds on the last.

THE LAZY-SHORTCUT TEST

Before you generate anything, ask what Chapter 6 asks of the finished pages: what is the quickest way a student could finish this without doing the thinking you intended? If the answer is copying, guessing or spotting a pattern, change the plan now. Add a decision, split the information or close the loophole.

For a real plan with its answers fixed first, see Chapter 10.

STRESS-TEST THE PLAN

You could try:

```
Here is my plan for a resource: [paste your plan]. Don't write the
resource. Tell me: (1) the quickest way a student could finish
without the thinking I intended; (2) anything the task can't be
done without that the plan doesn't supply; (3) any steps whose
timings don't add up; (4) any question where more than one answer
could be defended. List problems only; don't fix them.
```

Untested suggestion, like every prompt in this guide. It can miss problems or raise ones that aren't there, so decide which are real.

Keep the plan with the resource. It tells you what the resource was meant to do, which helps you choose between repairing it and starting again (Chapter 7).



FROM PLAN TO DRAFT

A broad request (“make me a worksheet”) hands the AI every decision at once. In the one-shot in Chapter 11, a single broad request produced sheets that contradicted each other. Drafting in parts keeps each piece small enough to check before the next depends on it.

DRAFT ONE PART AT A TIME

Work in parts, and check each part before you ask for the next. The parts depend on the resource. A reading task might go text, then questions; a vocabulary set, word list, then practice items; a short explanation, the explanation itself, then examples, then check questions. Teacher notes and the key come last, written from the finished student material.

The first prompt:

> Here is my plan for a resource: [paste the plan, including the answers]. Write only [the first part, for example the reading text, the student page or the first section]. Use only the information in the plan. Don’t write the questions, the teacher notes or the key yet. Level: [level]. Spelling: [US or UK]. If the plan is unclear or two parts of it disagree, tell me instead of choosing.

The second:

> Here is the finished [first part]: [paste it]. Now write [the next part, for example the questions that go with it] from the plan. Use only what is in the plan and in the part I’ve pasted, and don’t change the part I’ve pasted. If they disagree, tell me instead of choosing.

Repeat for each part, checking each one on its own before moving on (the student-only read in Chapter 6).

Variant for information-gap tasks. When each student holds different information, the parts are Student A's page, then Student B's, and each sheet may carry only its own facts:

```
Here is my plan for a resource: [paste the plan, including the
answers]. Write only the Student A page. Use only the facts that
belong on Student A's sheet. Don't write Student B's page, the
teacher notes or the key. Level: [level]. Spelling: [US or UK].
```

Then, with Student A's page checked:

```
Here is the finished Student A page: [paste it]. Now write Student
B's page from the plan. Don't repeat any fact that belongs only
on Student A's page, and don't change anything on Student A's
page. If the plan and Student A's page disagree, tell me instead
of choosing.
```

DERIVE THE KEY AND THE NOTES FROM THE PAGES

The answer key and teacher notes should come from the student pages as they now exist, not from the plan or from memory. That is how a key stays in step with the pages.

```
Here is the finished student material: [paste it]. Write the
teacher notes and the answer key from this material only. Don't
add any fact that isn't in it. For each answer, give the reason
using what is in the material. Then list anything in your notes or
key that isn't in the student material.
```

If the task has no single right answer (a discussion, an open writing task), the "key" becomes sample answers and a list of what to look for. Then check the relationship yourself:

- **Every fact in the key is on a student page.** If it isn't, the key is giving students something they were never given.
- **Every wrong option is ruled out by a stated fact** (for tasks with right answers). "All the others are on days she isn't free" is a claim to check, not to trust (Chapter 10 has a real case).

- **Page references are right.** Do them last, in the exported file (Chapter 8), because layout changes them.
- **Timings add up** to the time you state.

WHAT TEACHER NOTES SHOULD CONTAIN

Notes a colleague could run cold have six things:

1. What to print, with page numbers, and what to keep.
2. Timed steps that add up to the stated time.
3. Words to pre-teach.
4. What the teacher should and shouldn't say. For example: don't solve it for them; if they ask "Is this right?", say "Check with your partner" (in pair work); one hint after two minutes.
5. "Accept answers like…" and "Watch for…". The first saves marking disputes; the second names the likely stumble.
6. Support and challenge for students who need more or less.

LANGUAGE DESIGN FOR ENGLISH LEARNERS

If your students are learning English, the language they need is part of the design, not a bonus.

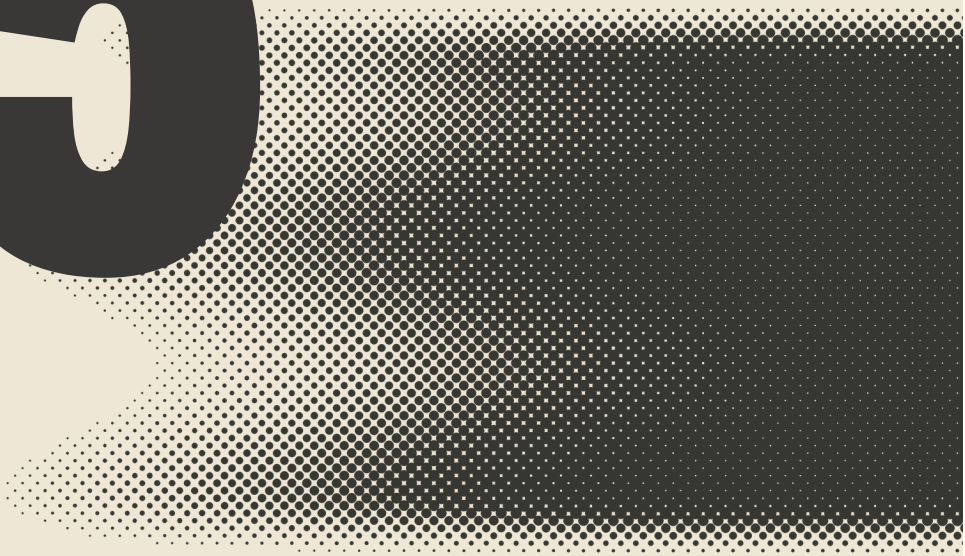
- **Put the questions on the page.** Three to five target questions on each sheet in an "Ask" strip, and two or three sentence frames in an "Explain" strip ("She can't join … because …").
- **Pre-teach what's above level.** List the words a student needs and doesn't know, and put them in the teacher notes with a time for teaching them. Check the finished text again for words that crept in during drafting.
- **Choose a language point on purpose.** One resource uses "free" to mean "not busy" on one sheet and "costs nothing" on the other, and the notes say so.

- **Teach how to be unsure.** Where students must reason from partial evidence, give them the language: “I think…”, “It seems…”, “We can’t be sure, but…”. A longer mystery activity in the same set of resources (The Last Day at Wonderland) opens with a short “Fact or Guess?” box that does this.
- **Decide your market’s English first.** US or UK spelling, “grade” or “year”, dollars or pounds. Then scan for the other kind. In a resource made while preparing this guide, British words (lost property, colour, football, Class 7B) had crept into material for a mostly US market; a scan for them found it.

KEEP YOUR ORIGINAL

Ask the AI to work on a copy. Keep your original untouched, and save each stage as its own version. A change you didn’t want is much easier to undo if the earlier file is still there.

5



WORK FROM WHAT YOU ALREADY HAVE

The most useful thing you can give an AI is something you've already made: last year's worksheet, a lesson you've taught many times, a list of questions, rough notes. The teaching is then yours, and the AI is adapting it.

> **Instead of:** "Make a reading comprehension worksheet about volcanoes for Grade 6."
>
> **Try:** "Here's the volcano text I wrote and the eight questions I use with it. Keep my text and my questions. Make a second version for students who need more support, with a word bank and the first two answers started for them."

SAY WHAT MUST NOT CHANGE

Left to itself, an AI may "improve" things you wanted kept. Name them in each request: your wording, the answers, the numbering, the order, the level.

ASK FOR PROBLEMS BEFORE A REWRITE

Ask it to list what it thinks is wrong (errors only, or unclear instructions) without rewriting anything. Then you choose what changes. You keep the decisions, and you see what it noticed before anything moves.

ASK FOR VERSIONS, AND SEE WHAT CHANGED

When you want an easier and a harder version, ask it to show only what it changed, so you can see exactly what moved. You could try:

> Here is my activity: [paste it]. Make an easier version with a word bank and a harder version with no sentence starters. Keep the same answers, numbering and order of questions. Don't reprint the whole activity. For each version, show me only the lines you changed, with the original wording beside each one.

Its list of changes may be incomplete or wrong, so compare the versions yourself. A change in one place can also leave the answer key, the notes or a matching version out of step; Chapter 7 shows how to check what depends on a change.



CHECK IT LIKE A USER

Before you repair anything, find out what's wrong. These checks ask you to use the resource the way someone else will: a student with one page, a teacher following your notes. None of them needs AI; most are careful reading.

There are two levels. The quick check is the minimum for anything you'll put in front of a class. The thorough check is for resources you'll share, reuse or build others from, or can't afford to get wrong. Neither has been timed or validated, so judge for yourself how long each takes.

THE QUICK CHECK

1. **Read each student page on its own.** Pretend it's the only page you've been given. Can you start? Do you know what you're meant to do, and is everything you need on this page?
2. **Do the task the lazy way.** Look for the quickest route to a finished sheet. If you can finish without the thinking you intended (copying, guessing, spotting a pattern), students can too. If copying or matching is the point, that's fine.
3. **Put the parts side by side.** Do the student material, notes and key agree about names, numbers and the situation (and, in an information-gap task, who holds what)? Solve the answers yourself, then compare with the key: every question has an answer, every answer has a question, and the numbering matches.
4. **Follow the teacher notes exactly as written.** Print what they say to print, use the page numbers they give, and see whether the timings add up. Then ask: could a colleague or supply teacher run this cold? Would they know what to print, how long it takes and where the answers are?
5. **Ask "who gets a copy of this page?"** Answers, teacher notes and worked examples shouldn't sit on a page students will receive. If a student page shows a worked example, make sure it isn't one of the questions they're meant to answer.
6. **Open the exported file and look at every page,** as your students will receive it. Chapter 8 covers this in detail.

Write down each problem with its page and line. Chapter 7 shows how to sort them and what to do next.

THE SAME CHECKS, OTHER RESOURCES

The quick check is written around a student page, notes and a key. Other resources need the same questions asked differently, and some need a check of their own. This table is the author's judgement, untried by other teachers; use the parts that fit.

RESOURCE	READ IT AS…	CHECK IT AGAINST…	ALSO CHECK
Worksheet or practice set	A student with only this page	Your own solved answers	Instructions that start without you
Reading text with questions	A student who hasn't heard your explanation	The text alone: every answer is findable in it	Facts against a source; reading level
Listening script	A listener who hears it as often as you plan, with no text	The questions: each answer is clearly stated aloud, not only implied	Read it aloud, timed: does it sound like speech? Names and numbers; any text-to-speech audio, listened to
Explanation or slides	A student new to the topic	A trusted source; nothing used before it is explained	Misconceptions named, not reinforced
Vocabulary practice	A student who knows only some words	One defensible answer per item, not guessable from the sentence	Same sense of each word throughout; level
Discussion task	A student who must talk for minutes	Does the question need a reason, not just yes or no?	Sentence frames; "what to look for" instead of a key
Assessment	A student who learned it, and one who didn't	Each item against a stated objective; could the second student pass by guessing?	Marking guidance a colleague could follow; items that give each other away; reading load that isn't the point
Information-gap or logic task	A student with only their own sheet	"Prove the answer", below, if there is one right answer	Who holds what; neither sheet works alone

The assessment row covers item quality only. For anything that counts towards a grade, follow your school's assessment rules.

An imagined example from another subject (not a record from this project). Suppose an AI adds a ninth question to the volcano set from Chapter 5, "Which layer of the Earth does magma come from?", and suppose your text never mentions the Earth's layers. Read as a student with only that text, as the table's reading-text row says: the answer can't be found in it. The key may be right, but the question tests something the text never taught. The repair is local: add the sentence or drop the question, then check the key against the text again. Nothing here depends on language learning or pairs.

THE THOROUGH CHECK

Add these to the quick check when the stakes are higher.

- **Facts.** Check anything you'd present as true (a date, a number, a "did you know") against a source you trust, note when you checked if it might change, and keep the source beside the fact. Solve answer keys yourself rather than trusting an AI-made one.
- **Ambiguity.** For each question, ask whether a second answer could be defended.
- **Level and age.** Judge the vocabulary and the thinking against your own students, not the AI's idea of a level. Mark words your weakest students wouldn't know, then pre-teach, replace or keep them.
- **Versions.** If there are matching versions (Student A and B, easier and harder), compare them for drift.

PROVE THE ANSWER (MATCHING AND LOGIC TASKS)

This section is for tasks with exactly one right arrangement of answers, such as matching and logic puzzles. It doesn't apply to open questions or discussion; for other tasks with right answers, ask the thorough check's "Ambiguity" question of each item. Here, "solve it yourself" isn't enough: you can solve the version you intended and miss a second solution, so test every possibility.

Take a pair task in which each student holds some clues. List every way the answer could be arranged, and test each arrangement against all the clues. Then run three tests:

1. **Exactly one solution** fits all the clues on both sheets. None means a clue is wrong; several means a clue is missing.
2. **Neither sheet works alone.** Test each sheet's clues on their own. Each should leave several answers.
3. **Each clue earns its place.** Remove the clues one at a time and see whether the answer is still unique.

Two real checks, both short scripts:

- **Which Club?** (Chapter 10): there are 120 ways to place four students in four of five clubs. Exactly one fits every fact on the two sheets.
- **Pet Street**, a puzzle with ten clues split between two sheets: together they leave one solution; Student A's clues alone leave 144 arrangements and Student B's alone 48. The checker also prints how many solutions remain with each clue removed in turn. For four of the ten the answer is still one, so on their own those clues add nothing to the logic. They may still help students confirm their work, but that should be a choice. The script's own comment says "no clue is redundant"; its printout says otherwise. A check that says one thing in its comments and another in its output is worth reading twice.

You don't need to write code. You could try:

```
Here are the clues on Sheet A and Sheet B: [paste them]. List
every way [the things being matched] can be matched so that all
the clues are true. Say how many there are and show each one. Then
do the same with Sheet A's clues only, and with Sheet B's only.
Don't suggest changes.
```

Check the AI's count by hand on a small case, or ask it for a short program you can run, and test the program on a puzzle where you know the answer. A tool can state a number it never worked out.

Scripts are optional. For a small puzzle, write out the possible arrangements on paper and cross off each one a clue rules out. Or give both sheets, without the key, to a colleague: a different answer, or getting stuck, means a clue is missing or ambiguous. One person solving it doesn't prove there is only one solution, because they may stop at the first they find; only a full list of possibilities, by hand or by script, does. Untested suggestions.

USING AN AI AS A SECOND PAIR OF EYES

An AI can read your pages and list suspected problems. That's another opinion, not verification: it can miss things, report problems that aren't there, and it can't see your printed page or know your students. Ask it to list problems, not fix them. A separate conversation from the one that made the resource may help; that's a reasoned suggestion, not something tested.

Three prompts you could try. Each does a different job.

> **Student-only read.** You are a [age] student. You have only the page below and no help from me. Tell me what you think you have to do, what confuses you, and whether you could finish. Then say what the quickest way to finish would be, even if it skips the thinking the task is meant to need. [paste one student page]
>
> **Fresh-eyes teacher review.** You are an experienced [subject] teacher seeing this resource for the first time. List problems only; don't rewrite anything. Think about the lesson: instructions that wouldn't work with a real class, timings that don't add up, anything a colleague would need that is missing, level problems, filler nobody would use. [paste student pages, teacher notes and answer key]
>
> **Facts, answers and consistency.** Here are the student pages, teacher notes and answer key. Change nothing. (1) Solve each question yourself first, then list any where your answer differs from the key or where more than one answer could be defended. (2) List every factual claim a teacher would present as true, so I can check them against sources; don't tell me they are correct. (3) List any differences between the pages in names, numbers, page references, timings or the situation described. [paste everything]

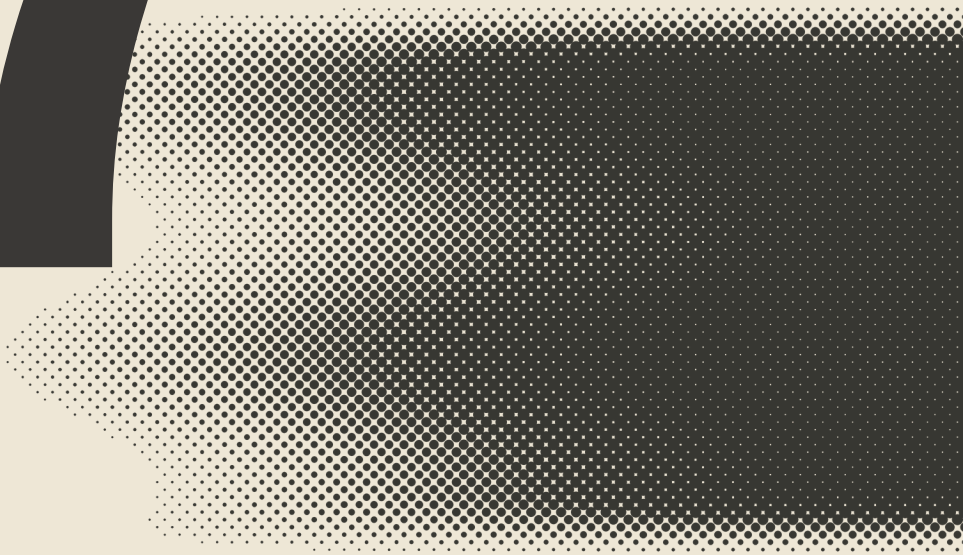
For the third prompt especially, check any "solved" answers yourself.

Re-review your fixes. A fix needs a check too. In a defect log kept while making a lost-property speaking activity, a fix for groups of three put all three claimants of one bottle with the same student, so the planned argument couldn't happen. A second review caught it.

TEST YOUR CHECKS

A check that never finds anything may not be working. Before you trust "nothing found", try it on something you know is there: search a PDF for a word you can see on the page, or plant a deliberate mistake in a copy and see whether your check catches it. In the same defect log, a level check never failed because a slip in its search pattern stopped it matching anything; it began finding problems once it was fixed.

7



DIAGNOSE AND REPAIR

You've spotted a problem in a resource an AI helped you make. The aim now is a small, checked repair, not another request to "make it better". Sometimes the right call is to bin the draft and start again from your plan.

SORT WHAT YOU'VE FOUND

Run the quick checks from Chapter 6, then sort each problem. **Cosmetic:** nobody would be misled. **Local:** one named place is wrong and you can say what right looks like. **Structural:** the task isn't doing what you wanted, or problems depend on each other. Local problems suit the method below; for structural ones, go back to your plan.

SYMPTOM FIRST, CAUSE SECOND

A symptom is what you notice. A cause is your best explanation, and it stays a hypothesis until you've checked; one symptom can have several.

For example: your notes say "keep page 4 for the answer key", but the key seems to be on page 6. Before changing anything: does the source still say page 4? Has the layout moved the key? Does the exported PDF match your editor? The cause could be the notes (written before the layout settled), the layout (a section grew) or the export settings.

SYMPTOM	POSSIBLE CAUSES (TO INVESTIGATE)	CONTROLLED REPAIR	RE-CHECK
Pages contradict each other	Pages may have been drafted separately, with no shared situation fixed	State the shared facts once; correct only the page that disagrees	Both student sheets, notes, key
Page references or page count don't match the file	Notes may predate the layout, or the layout may have changed since	Settle the layout, then correct the references; reflow if lines have spilled over	Each reference against the real page order

SYMPTOM	POSSIBLE CAUSES (TO INVESTIGATE)	CONTROLLED REPAIR	RE-CHECK
Students can finish without the thinking you intended (if copying or matching is the point, this is fine)	The task may need no decision, or one detail may give the answer away	No decision: return to your plan. A giveaway: change only that detail	Solve it as a student hunting for the quickest route
More than one answer fits, or no answer does	A clue is missing, wrong or ambiguous	Fix or add one clue; keep the intended answer	For a matching or logic task, run the "Prove the answer" test again (Chapter 6); otherwise ask again whether a second answer could be defended
Answers appear on a page students will receive	Answers may share a page with student material, or a pattern may point to them	Move teacher material to its own page; remove the pattern	For each page: who gets a copy of this?
Answers remain findable in the file after being covered	A box may have been drawn over the text, hiding it without removing it	Rebuild the page without the answers	Search the exported file for a word from an answer; check any preview
A repair changed things you didn't ask for	The request may not have said what to keep	Say what must stay; ask what changed; undo unwanted changes	Compare old and new yourself
Wording sounds unnatural	The context may have been vague	Rewrite only the marked lines, saying who is speaking to whom	Read it aloud as the student would
Language is above or below your students' level	Your students' level may not have been stated, or the AI's idea of it may differ from yours	Replace or pre-teach the hard words; ask for simpler versions of those lines only	Read as a student; check key and notes still match

SYMPTOM	POSSIBLE CAUSES (TO INVESTIGATE)	CONTROLLED REPAIR	RE-CHECK
A fact may be wrong	Fluent text isn't evidence; the AI may have stated something false or out of date	Check a reliable source; correct or remove only that claim	Every other place the fact appears
Meaning depends on colour	The design may have assumed colour printing	Add a label, border or symbol	Print one page in black and white

If the same flaw keeps recurring across resources, see Chapter 9.

CONTROLLED REPAIR, STEP BY STEP

1. **Pin down the symptom:** page, line, what you saw.
2. **Investigate the likely cause:** list two or three possibilities and check the cheapest first. An AI's suggestions about causes are hypotheses too.
3. **Define what must not change:** a keep list of answers, numbering, page order, particular wording.
4. **Make the smallest appropriate repair:** one defect at a time. Sometimes editing by hand is quickest.
5. **Check the repair and its dependencies.** Before changing anything, note which of these it could touch, then check only those: the answer key; teacher instructions (steps, timings, page references); numbering; page count and order; information repeated elsewhere (names, times, quantities); matching versions (A/B, easier/harder). Compare old and new for changes you didn't ask for.
6. **Inspect the finished output.** Open the exported file itself and check its page order, references and text, and print a copy if you'll hand it out on paper. Chapter 8 covers how. Neither shows whether students will understand it.
7. **Decide:** retain, revise or discard.

If you ask an AI to make the change, you could try:

```
Here is [the page or text].
Problem: [what is wrong, and where].
Change only: [the material you permit, for example the page
references in the teacher notes]. Change nothing else.
Keep exactly as it is: [your keep list].
If you think the change affects anything else (the answer key,
say), tell me what and why, but don't change it unless I say so.
Then tell me what you changed.
```

The tool may still change what you told it to keep, and its account of its changes may be incomplete or wrong. Compare the actual versions yourself; don't rely on its report.

RETAIN, REVISE OR DISCARD

- **Retain** when the problem is fixed, the dependencies check out, the finished output looks right and you'd hand it to a colleague.
- **Revise** when a repair worked but exposed another local problem; carry on while each fix stays small and you can say what it touched.
- **Discard and restart** when repairs keep creating problems elsewhere, you can't say what the task now is, or the problem is structural. Keep the plan; the draft is the disposable part.



CHECK THE FINISHED FILE

A resource can look right in your editor and still go wrong in the file students receive. Chapter 6 asked whether it works and Chapter 7 how to repair it; this chapter is about the file itself.

Not every resource is a PDF. For slides, a shared document, an online quiz or a text you'll read aloud, check the form students actually receive (run the slideshow, open the link as a student, take the quiz), not your editing view. The points on page breaks and printing are for printed and PDF material; the rest apply to any format.

THREE DIFFERENT CHECKS

- **On screen, in your editor or the AI's preview.** This shows what you made. It doesn't show what the exported file contains.
- **The exported PDF, opened on screen.** This shows the page count, order, breaks and text as exported. It doesn't show how a printer will reproduce it.
- **A physical print.** This shows margins, legibility, shading and double-sided behaviour on that printer. It doesn't show whether students will understand the task.

Each can catch problems the others can't, and none stands in for the others. In the one-shot in Chapter 11, a reply said it had tightened the spacing "so each student sheet fits on one A4 page", yet the exported PDF still ran each sheet onto a second page. No physical print of that file is recorded.

EXPORT, THEN OPEN THE FILE

1. **Export to the format and paper size you'll actually use.** Check the page size rather than assuming it.
2. **Open the exported file itself,** not the document it came from and not the AI's description of it. Count the pages.
3. **Re-export after every change.** A fix is a new version.

LOOK AT EVERY PAGE

- **Page count, order and content** match your plan and notes: every page, table and image you expected is there.

- **Overflow and breaks.** Look for anything cut off, overlapping or off the edge, pages holding only a line or two, and headings left at the foot of a page with their text on the next.
- **Leftovers.** “TODO”, “draft”, file names, version numbers, internal codes, prompt text in an image. Search for them, having first tested your search (Chapter 6).
- **The right things on the right pages.** Student pages carry no answers, and the teacher notes and key aren’t on a page students will receive. Check the page references in your notes against this file.
- **Real text.** Select and search for a word you can see. Looking at a page doesn’t tell you what text sits under it.
- **Hidden isn’t removed.** If an answer was covered with a box, the text may still be in the file. Search the exported file for a word from an answer. The same goes for previews and thumbnails you share: check the preview file itself, not the original.
- **Images.** Zoom in: stray lettering or odd details are easier to see at full size.

Two real cases from this project’s own files:

- **A title that looked right but searched wrong.** In Which Club?, a playful outlined title looked correct on screen and in print, yet extracted from the PDF as repeated letters (for example “llleeeooo”), so it couldn’t be searched or copied. Only extracting the text showed it. The cause was the browser’s PDF output writing extra copies of text for each outline or shadow effect. The fix was to draw the outline and shadow as shapes and keep one normal line of text on top.
- **A preview that hid the answers badly.** For another resource, the preview’s answer page was covered by a drawn box, but the answers were still extractable text. The preview build’s own check, which extracted the covered page’s text, caught it. The fix was true redaction.

READABILITY AND CONTRAST

Read the page at the size it will be printed. Light grey text, pale tints and small print can vanish on paper. Don't let colour alone carry meaning; add a label, border or symbol.

PRINTING

If you print the resource, print one copy on the printer you'll use, in black and white if that's normal for you. Check that shading and small text are still legible, that nothing is clipped at the margins, and what's on the back of each sheet if you print double-sided. For paired sheets such as Student A and Student B, make sure the back of one doesn't carry the other, or print single-sided. If you haven't printed it, know what you have and haven't checked.

IF YOU SHARE OR SELL IT

A listing is another document to check. Its title, description, previews and bundle contents are claims about the file, so check them against the exported file, not your memory of it.

- **Facts.** File type, page count, paper size and what is included (key, notes) match what you say. A bundle holds exactly the items it lists.
- **Previews** show no answers and no leftovers (the preview case above).
- **Claims.** Don't claim what you can't support, such as "classroom-tested", "proven" or "standards-aligned".
- **The file buyers get.** Download it as a buyer would and open it; the file you uploaded may not be the file you checked.
- **Rules and honesty.** Platforms set their own rules on AI-assisted material, previews and ownership; check the current ones; Chapter 12 covers ownership. This guide hasn't verified any. Don't describe a resource as made by hand if it wasn't.

If you use AI to help draft the description, you could try:

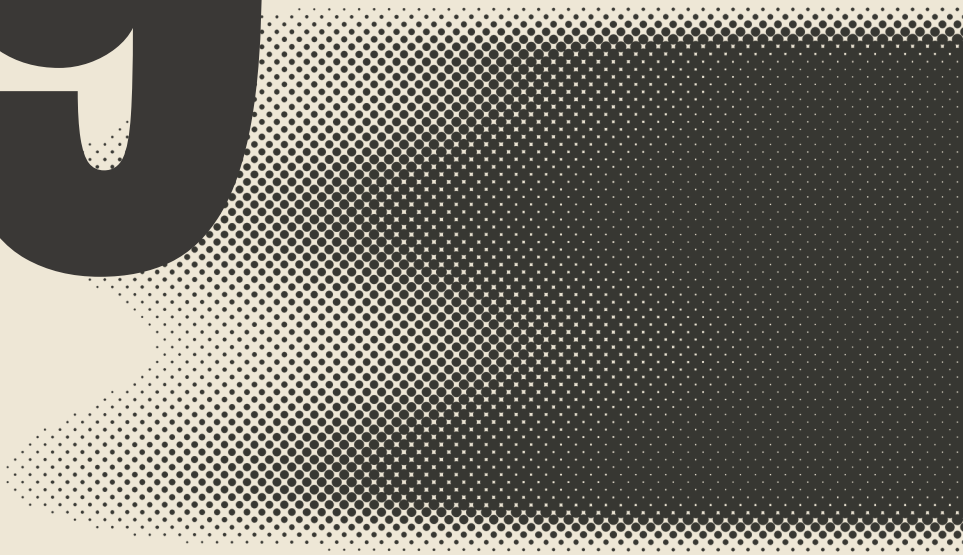
```
Here is the finished resource: [paste it]. Here is my draft
listing: [paste it]. Change nothing. List every statement in the
listing that the resource doesn't support, that overstates it, or
that I would need evidence for.
```

Untested; it can miss claims, so check the listing against the file yourself.

AFTER A REPAIR

Export again and look at the whole file, not just the page you changed. A change can move text onto a new page, shift page numbers or break a reference. Check the page count, order and references again, then use the decision in Chapter 7: retain, revise or discard.

9



MAKE QUALITY REPEATABLE

Checking one resource well is useful. Not having to rediscover the same mistake in the next resource is better. This chapter is about turning what you find into a few habits that last.

KEEP A MISTAKES LOG

When a check or a repair turns up a problem, add one line to a running list: what went wrong, then the rule that would have prevented it. These rows come from this project's own records:

MISTAKE	RULE
A preview page hid the answers under a drawn box, but the text was still in the file	Search the exported file for an answer word before sharing
A student sheet told the student to "ask the owner" when only a partner was in the room	Read each sheet as someone holding only that page
A decorative title looked right but searched as repeated letters	Extract and search the text of every exported page, not just look at it
An answer key printed the production tool's internal codes; a shared template had put them in 29 of 30 activities audited	Fix the template, then scan every resource made from it for the same words
British words in a resource for a US market	Decide your market's English before drafting; scan for the other kind
(your own example)	*(your own rule)*

Keep the rules short and in your own words. After a few resources, the same rules will keep appearing. Those are the ones to build into your routine.

The template case is the one to remember. A single flaw in a shared template reached almost every answer key before anyone looked. Once it was found, a scan for the internal terms was added to the build, so a package containing them is now flagged before release.

TURN THE LOG INTO A CHECKLIST

Take the rules that recur and make them your own checklist, one line each. The quick check in Chapter 6 is a starting point. Add your recurring rules and remove any you never need. A checklist of five lines you use beats one

of twenty you don't.

WRITE A STYLE SHEET

If you make several resources, write a short list of what yours should and shouldn't look and sound like. For example: "US English and 'grade' not 'year'; real-world settings; no mascots; no filler 'fun facts'; plain, friendly instructions; same names for the same things on every page." Give it to the AI at the start of a task. It helps keep your materials consistent, but you still check the result against it.

REUSE A TEMPLATE WITHOUT COPYING ITS FLAW

A template is a shortcut, and it also copies whatever is wrong with it into every resource you make from it. Before reusing one:

1. **Re-check the template itself** as if it were a new resource, including the exported file.
2. **Change the content, then check what depends on it.** Titles, names, page references, answers and counts are the usual things left behind from the last use.
3. **Search for leftovers** from the previous topic (Chapter 8).
4. **If you find a flaw, fix the template,** not just the copy in front of you, and add a line to your log.

AFTER YOU'VE USED IT

Teaching a resource tells you things no check can. If you can, try a new resource first with a small group or in a colleague's class, giving as little help as you can. Ask two or three students what they thought they had to do; their answers can show what your own reading missed. While you remember, note:

- **Where students stalled or asked.** A question that came up three times points to a gap in the instructions or the content.
- **What they did that you didn't expect.** A wrong answer many gave may be a misconception, or a question that misled; an unexpected right answer may mean the key is incomplete.

- **Whether they produced the evidence you planned** (Chapter 3), or only looked busy.
- **Timing against your notes,** and anything you changed on the spot.

Then decide as in Chapter 7: retain, revise (updating the plan, notes, key and log together) or discard. One class is a signal, not proof, and it is the evidence this guide's own examples lack (Appendix B). Note patterns, not names, and read Chapter 12 before you paste classroom notes or student work into an AI service.

KEEP A PROJECT NOTE

Keep a short note with the plan, the decisions you've made and your keep list. You can paste it into a new conversation, so the AI starts from what you decided and not from a guess.

10

WORKED EXAMPLE: WHICH CLUB?

This chapter follows one real resource through the method from its plan onward: **Which Club?**, a four-page partner speaking task for English learners (about level B1, ages 10 to 14, about 25 minutes). Everything below comes from the project's records for that resource. It was made with AI, checked as described here, and has not been used with students.

Which Club? is an information-gap task, so some checks below are specific to that format (who holds what, a unique solution). The table in Chapter 6 shows how the checks change for other resources. This chapter demonstrates planning, drafting and checking, not a completed classroom trial. The objective-to-format step in Chapter 3 came after this resource was made, so the example starts at the plan; and because it hasn't been used, it has no after-use step.

THE PLAN

The plan was written before any page existed. It followed the plan step in an early draft of this guide. Its main lines:

- **Students finish by** deciding which after-school club each of four students should join, and which club nobody can join, with a "because" for each.
- **They can't do it without** both sheets. Student A has notes from four students: the days they're free, when they must be home, money, age and what they want. Student B has the school's list of five clubs: days, times, cost and requirements.
- **The tricky part:** most students have two clubs that look possible until a detail on the other sheet rules one out. One club, Coding, suits nobody.
- **Target language:** questions (What day is it on? How much does it cost? Is there an age limit?) and reasons (She can't join … because …).
- **Not included, on purpose:** story padding, real school names and made-up facts to verify.

The answers were fixed in the plan, before any text was written:

STUDENT	CLUB, AND THE DECIDING FACTS
Maya, 11	Drama. She is free only on Wednesdays and Thursdays; Coding (Thursdays) is for ages 12 and up; Drama is free of charge

STUDENT	CLUB, AND THE DECIDING FACTS
Leo, 13	Chess. He is free on Mondays and Thursdays but must be home by 4:15 on Thursdays, so Coding (ends 4:30) is out; he has no money and Chess is free
Sara, 12	Basketball. She is free Tuesday, Thursday and Friday, has $5 a month and Basketball costs $5; she hasn't done the beginners' coding course; Art needs Mondays
Omar, 14	Art. He is free on Mondays and Fridays, has $3 a month and Art costs $3; he already plays chess and wants something different
Nobody	Coding. Maya is too young; Leo must be home by 4:15; Sara hasn't done the course; Omar isn't free on Thursdays

WHAT THE PAGES HOLD

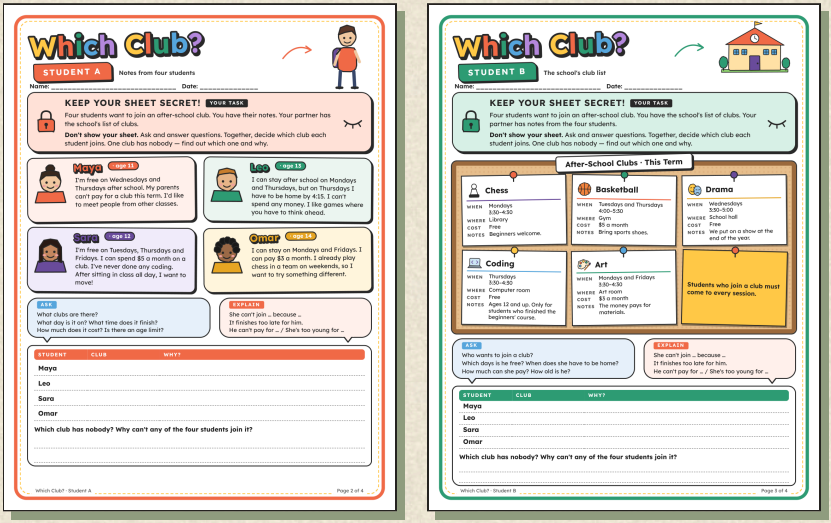


Figure 2. Student A (left) and Student B (right) pages of Which Club?

Page 1 is the teacher notes (aim, timed steps, words to pre-teach, support and challenge); pages 2 and 3 are the student sheets; page 4 is the answer key. The notes say to print page 2 for each Student A and page 3 for each Student B, and to keep pages 1 and 4.

Chapter 4's lessons are visible here. Each sheet has an Ask strip and an Explain strip. The notes pre-teach "term", "materials", "beginners' course" and "age limit". "Free" means "not busy" on Student A's sheet and "costs nothing" on Student B's, and the notes and the key both flag it. The key lists "Accept answers like…" and "Watch for…". The records don't say whether the pieces were drafted one at a time; Chapter 4 describes the order this guide recommends.

PROVING THE ANSWER

This step suits puzzle-type tasks (Chapter 6), and a script is one way to do it, not a requirement. A short script lists every way to place the four students in four different clubs (120 ways) and tests each against only the facts on the two sheets. Exactly one fits: Maya in Drama, Leo in Chess, Sara in Basketball, Omar in Art, with Coding left empty. A text search confirmed that Student A's page contains no club facts and Student B's page contains no student facts, so neither sheet works alone.

One more result came from running the script again for this guide, with Omar's chess clue ("I already play chess… I want to try something different") removed. There was still exactly one solution, because Leo's constraints already force Chess. That clue isn't needed by the logic. It gives Omar a reason, which may be exactly why it's there, but it should be a decision. The script does not test for redundant clues; the Pet Street checker in Chapter 6 does.

THE DEFECTS, AND HOW THEY WERE FOUND

The resource's quality check records these.

WHAT WAS WRONG	WHAT WAS DONE, AND HOW IT WAS FOUND WHERE THE RECORD SAYS
The first render overflowed pages 1 to 3; page 3 by 182 pixels	Found by measuring in the browser before printing. Spacing tightened; no content removed
The key said "All other clubs are on days she isn't free" for Maya. That was wrong: Basketball meets on Thursday, when she is free. It is ruled out because it also needs Tuesday	Found while checking the key against the sheets. Wording corrected, with the same fix for Leo

WHAT WAS WRONG	WHAT WAS DONE, AND HOW IT WAS FOUND WHERE THE RECORD SAYS
The "why not" column for Leo didn't cover Basketball and Drama	Found in the same check. Added
The "When" column wrapped to three lines and pushed the last writing line onto the footer	Column widened
The notes said of a stuck pair, "this is often why", which nothing supported	Found while re-reading claims against the evidence. Softened to "this may be why"
After a visual redesign, the title extracted as repeated letters	Found by extracting the text; looking at the page showed nothing wrong (Chapter 8). Outline and shadow redrawn as shapes; the word is now one normal line of text
After the redesign, had anything changed in the content?	An automated check that every text string of the earlier version still appears on the same page, plus a rerun of the logic script: still exactly one solution

WHAT WAS AND WASN'T CHECKED

- **Checked:** the logic (exhaustively); that each sheet lacks the other's facts; that every fact in the key is on a student page and every rejected club is ruled out by a stated fact; page references; timings (the four steps add up to 26 minutes against "about 25"); leftovers; that the text extracts and searches normally; every page viewed in colour and in greyscale.
- **Not checked:** the checks were done by the same AI that built the resource, as its quality check says. A second teacher reading it cold would be a useful independent check. No physical print is recorded. The 25 minutes and the B1 level are estimates, and the only way to confirm them is to run it with a class. That hasn't happened.

WHAT TO TAKE FROM IT

Fix the answers in the plan, so there is something to check the pages against. Test the answer by listing every possibility, if it is a puzzle-type task; for other tasks, ask whether a second answer could be defended. Check the key against the pages, fact by fact. Look at the page, then extract its text: each caught different things.

11

WHAT A ONE-SHOT LOOKS LIKE

This chapter follows one small test from request to repair. It shows what the checks in Chapters 6 to 8 are for. It is one resource, one model family and one AI-written request, so treat it as an illustration, not as evidence of how often any of this happens. It uses an information-gap task because that is what was being tested; the checks it exercises (reading as a user, checking what a repair touches, opening the exported file) are not specific to that format. Chapter 10 shows the other side: a resource made from a plan and checked.

THE REQUEST

The test used this request, written to stand for ordinary use:

> I teach ESL to middle school students (around B1 level). Can you make me a printable information gap speaking activity about a lost property office? I need a Student A sheet, a Student B sheet, short teacher instructions and an answer key. It should take about 20 minutes. Please make it look nice and give it to me as one HTML file I can print to PDF.

A Claude Sonnet-family model answered it as an ordinary chat assistant would, with no research or checking. The exact model version wasn't recorded. The HTML was printed to PDF with no edits. The record describes the printing as "US Letter, default margins", but the first output's HTML sets A4 and both PDFs are A4; the discrepancy is unresolved.

WHAT CAME BACK

Six pages: Student A, then a page holding only Task 3, then Student B, another Task 3 page, the teacher notes and the key. Reading it as a user (Chapter 6) found:

- **The sheets contradicted each other.** Student A's sheet said the partner held the list of items people *found*. Student B's said the partner held a list of things people *lost*. Both tables were headed "Lost items (what people reported)".
- **The teacher notes didn't match the file.** They said to print pages 1 and 2 separately and keep page 4 as the answer key. In the file, Student B was on page 3 and the key on page 6.

- **The workload was uneven.** Student A had seven blanks to fill and Student B eleven.

Nothing here depends on the text being machine-made. A person could have written the same contradiction. It is slop in this book's sense because nobody had yet examined it for use.

ONE ORDINARY FOLLOW-UP

A fresh model instance was given only the output and this message:

> Thanks! Before I print this for my class, can you check the whole activity for any problems (anything confusing, wrong, or that wouldn't work in a real classroom or when printed) and fix them? Give me the improved version as one HTML file.

The reply listed ten fixes. Comparing the new file with the claims:

	THE REPLY'S CLAIM OR ADVICE	WHAT THE EXPORTED FILE SHOWED
Fixed	"Both sheets now say you each have the same list of six reports, with different gaps"	Both sheets now describe the same list, with different gaps
Fixed	"I rebalanced the list so each student has 9"	Nine blanks each, up from seven and eleven. The key and the teacher note were updated to match
Not fixed	"It now says to keep pages 3 and 4 and not hand them out"	The revised notes said "print pages 1 and 2… Keep pages 3 and 4". In the exported file, page 3 contains Student B and page 4 contains only Task 3; the notes are on page 5 and the key on page 6. The reference was arguably worse than before, because it now described Student B's page as teacher material

	THE REPLY'S CLAIM OR ADVICE	WHAT THE EXPORTED FILE SHOWED
Claim not borne out	"I tightened the spacing and font sizes so each student sheet fits on one A4 page"	Still six pages. The "Task 3" heading sat at the foot of pages 1 and 3, with its question alone on pages 2 and 4
Advice, not a file finding	"I could not preview the printout here, so please do a quick print preview"	The reply was accurate about its limit. The file can't show whether printing will work, and no print of it is recorded

WHAT THIS SHOWS

- **A broad request produced a broad reply.** "Check the whole activity" returned a list of confident changes. Some were real. Others weren't borne out, and the reply didn't separate them.
- **A repair can change a reference without checking it.** The blank rebalance updated its dependents (key and count); the page-reference fix didn't. That is the dependency list from Chapter 7.
- **A claim about the file isn't a check of the file.** Only opening the exported PDF showed the sheets still ran over. This is Chapter 8.

A controlled repair of the page-reference problem would follow Chapter 7. That wasn't tried, so how it would have performed is untested. No print of these files and no use with students is recorded.

12

RESPONSIBLE USE

The rules depend on your country, your school and the AI service. This chapter points to what to check. It isn't legal advice.

PUPIL INFORMATION

Department for Education (DfE) guidance for schools and colleges in England, updated 12 August 2025, recommends that personal data is not used in generative AI tools. Don't paste identifiable pupil information or other sensitive material into a general AI service unless you've checked that it's permitted.

PUPILS' WORK

The same guidance says schools must not allow pupils' original work to be used to train AI models without permission, or an applicable exception to copyright. It notes that some free tools use what you enter for training, and that some paid tools let you opt out.

THE SERVICE'S TERMS AND YOUR SCHOOL'S POLICY

Check the AI service's current terms on keeping your data and training its models. That is practical advice, not something the guidance states. Check your school's or employer's policy too, and ask if it isn't clear.

COPYRIGHT AND OWNERSHIP

This depends on where you are. In the United States, the Copyright Office concluded in January 2025 that prompts alone are unlikely to make you the author of AI output, while human selection, arrangement or modification can be protected. That is US analysis, not UK law. In March 2026 the UK government signalled a preference to remove protection for wholly computer-generated works while keeping it for works made with AI assistance, but had not committed to it; no law had changed.

So don't assume you own, or can sell, what an AI produces. Check the rules where you live, the terms of the AI service you used and the licence on anything you feed in.

FACTS AND SUITABILITY

DfE says AI content needs critical judgement to check its appropriateness and accuracy, and that the professional remains responsible for the final document. Check facts, answers and suitability yourself (Chapter 6).

ACCESSIBILITY

Don't let colour be the only signal, and make sure text has enough contrast (Chapter 8). WCAG 2.2 is a web-content standard that states the colour principle. It doesn't govern printed worksheets, and borrowing its ideas doesn't make a resource compliant.

Sources are listed under "Sources (Chapter 12)" at the end of the book.

APPENDIX



CHECKLIST

Tick what you have checked, not what you assume. Some items apply only to some resources, and are marked. Neither check has been timed or validated, and neither guarantees quality.

PLAN AND DRAFT

- ☐ Objective and evidence settled first, then the format that suits them.
- ☐ Plan written: what students finish by, level, time, layout (and, for an information-gap task, who holds what).
- ☐ Answers decided before any text was drafted.
- ☐ Drafted one part at a time; each part checked before the next.
- ☐ Teacher notes and key written from the finished student pages.

QUICK CHECK

- ☐ Each student page, read on its own: can you start, and is everything you need there?
- ☐ The task done the lazy way: can you finish without the thinking you intended?
- ☐ Parts side by side: names, numbers and situation agree (and, in an information-gap task, who holds what).
- ☐ Answers solved yourself and compared with the key; numbering matches.
- ☐ Teacher notes followed exactly: what to print, page numbers, timings.
- ☐ Each page: who gets a copy? No answers or teacher notes on student pages.
- ☐ Exported file opened and every page looked at.

THOROUGH CHECK

- ☐ Student instructions: could a student start without you?
- ☐ The task needs the intended thinking, not just copying or guessing (unless that is the point).
- ☐ Sheets, notes and key agree; matching versions (A/B, easier/harder) have not drifted.
- ☐ Matching and logic tasks only: every possibility tested, by script or by hand; exactly one solution; (information gap) neither sheet works alone.

- ☐ The checks in the Chapter 6 table that fit this kind of resource.
- ☐ Every fact in the key is on a student page; every wrong option ruled out by a stated fact.
- ☐ Facts checked against a source you trust, with the date noted if it may change.
- ☐ Each question: could a second answer be defended?
- ☐ Level and age judged against your own students; hard words pre-taught, replaced or kept.
- ☐ Spelling and terms match your market; nothing left from the other kind.
- ☐ Page order, page breaks and page references checked in the exported PDF.
- ☐ Text of the exported file searched: no leftovers, no hidden answers, no repeated letters.

IF YOU SHARE OR SELL IT

- ☐ Title, description, preview and bundle contents checked against the exported file.
- ☐ Previews show no answers; no claim you can't support; the downloaded file opened as a buyer would.

AFTER USE

- ☐ Tried first with a few students, if possible, and asked what they thought they had to do.
- ☐ Notes made after teaching it: where students stalled, whether they produced the evidence you planned, what surprised you, timing, what you changed. Patterns, not names.
- ☐ Plan, notes, key and mistakes log updated.

MY OWN RECURRING CHECKS

- ☐ _____

APPENDIX



EVIDENCE NOTES AND LIMITS

WHAT THE EXAMPLES ARE

- **Chapter 10 (Which Club?)** is a real resource from the project. Its plan, logic script and quality check are the source for the chapter. The one added result (Omar's clue) came from running the logic script again with that clue removed. The resource has not been used with students, and its first quality check was done by the AI that built it.
- **Chapter 6 (Pet Street)** reports the output of that resource's own checker, run again for this guide.
- **Chapter 11 (Lost Property)** is one test: one request, one model, one follow-up. The files are the first output, the revised output and the follow-up reply. One case cannot show how AI generally behaves or how often any defect occurs.
- **The "mistakes log" rows** come from the project's defect log and quality checks. The template case (internal codes in answer keys) comes from project audit notes of 6 October 2026: after one activity's answer key was found to print the production tool's codes, an audit of the other published activities found the same wording in 29 of 30. The build code records the reason a scan for those terms was added. The audited files were replaced and are not kept for re-inspection, so the figure of 29 of 30 rests on those notes.
- **The fractions, volcano and magma-question examples** in Chapters 1, 5 and 6 are imagined for illustration, not records from the project.
- **The cover worksheet** is a made-up example supplied by the author for this guide. It is not taken from any real publisher or product.

HOW THE LOST PROPERTY TEST WAS PRODUCED

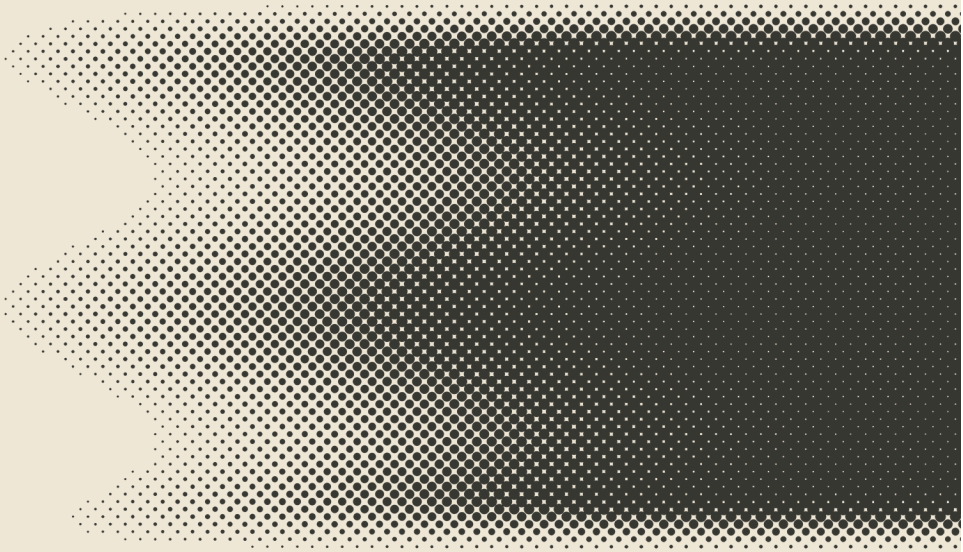
Each version came from a fresh instance of a Sonnet-family model, run as a sub-agent. The exact model version was not recorded. The request and the project's own assessments were written by AI. The printing-setup discrepancy noted in Chapter 11 is unresolved.

WHAT IS MISSING

No classroom use of any example resource is recorded. No physical print of the Lost Property files is recorded. No independent human check of the examples is recorded. The prompts in this guide have not been tested, and neither has the table in Chapter 6, which is the author's judgement.

AI-USE NOTE

AI tools were used extensively in developing this guide, including drafting and revising text, generating teaching-resource examples, and analysing the outputs produced during the case study. The author directed the work, supplied the cover worksheet and decided what to publish. The project's records do not show a line-by-line human edit of the text, and none is claimed.



SOURCES (CHAPTER 12)

- Department for Education (England), *Generative artificial intelligence (AI) in education*, guidance, updated 12 August 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/generative-artificial-intelligence-in-education
- US Copyright Office, *Copyright and Artificial Intelligence, Part 2: Copyrightability*, January 2025. https://www.copyright.gov/ai/Copyright-and-Artificial-Intelligence-Part-2-Copyrightability-Report.pdf
- UK Government (DSIT and DCMS), *Report on Copyright and Artificial Intelligence*, published 18 March 2026. https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/report-and-impact-assessment-on-copyright-and-artificial-intelligence
- W3C, *Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2*, W3C Recommendation, 12 December 2024. https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/